MILO WAVE GUIDES · 2026 EDITION

Top 15 AI Tools & Prompts for Music Producers in 2026

Real workflows, copy-paste prompts, and honest takes on every tool worth your time right now.

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INTRODUCTION

How to Use This Guide

Let's skip the "AI is changing music forever" speech. You already know that. What you probably don't have is a clear, honest breakdown of *which* tools are actually worth your time right now — and exactly how to use them.

Every tool in here was picked because it solves a real problem producers face: creative blocks, slow workflows, expensive plugins you can't afford, or just not knowing where to start with AI. The prompts are copy-paste ready. The workflows are real.

Prices and free tiers change fast. Always check current pricing on each tool's website before purchasing.

Each tool entry includes:

- **What it does** — the one-sentence version
- **Best for** — who gets the most out of it
- **Free tier** — yes/no and what you actually get
- ⚡ **The workflow** — how to actually use it in a session
- **Prompts** — copy-paste examples ready to go
- **Honest take** — what's great, what's not, no fluff

Tools are grouped by use case, not ranked by preference. Jump to whatever you need.

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SECTION 01

AI Music Generation

1 Suno

suno.com

✓ Free tier

Best for: Ideation · Reference tracks · Demo vocals

What it does: Generates complete songs — vocals, instruments, production — from a text prompt in seconds.

The workflow: Use Suno to generate 4–6 variations of a rough idea before you've written a single note. Think of it as an AI mood board for your track. Pick the direction that resonates, then build around it in your DAW. Add "instrumental" to any prompt to skip the AI vocals and get a clean backing track.

COPY-PASTE PROMPTS

```
Moody lo-fi hip hop, dusty vinyl crackle, muted trumpet, late night 3am feeling,
slow tempo, instrumental
```

```
Dark trap beat, 808 sub bass, eerie choir sample, minor key, Atlanta influence,
aggressive energy, instrumental
```

```
Indie folk, fingerpicked acoustic guitar, warm vocals, melancholy but hopeful,
Phoebe Bridgers influence, sparse production
```

HONEST TAKE

The production quality is genuinely impressive and keeps improving. Best use is ideation and reference — not final release material (yet). The vocal style can sound generic; use the instrumental outputs and layer your own vocals for better results. Free credits renew daily — enough for regular ideation sessions.

2 Udio

udio.com

✓ Free tier

Best for: Genre blending · Niche styles · Song structure sketching

What it does: Text-to-song generation with a focus on stylistic variety and genre blending. Similar to Suno but different engine, different results.

The workflow: Udio handles genre blending better than Suno. Use it when you're trying to create something that doesn't fit neatly into one genre box. The "extend" feature is powerful — generate a verse, extend to chorus, extend to bridge. Great for mapping out full song structure quickly.

COPY-PASTE PROMPTS

```
Afrobeats meets UK garage, percussive, syncopated rhythm, warm bassline, summer energy, no vocals
```

```
Neo-soul jazz fusion, Rhodes piano, brushed drums, walking bass, introspective mood, late night session
```

```
Hyperpop, glitchy production, pitched up vocals, 140bpm, chaotic energy, PC Music influence
```

> **HONEST TAKE**
>
> Udio and Suno are close in quality in 2026 — worth having accounts on both and running the same prompt through each to compare. Different engines produce meaningfully different results for the same input. Run both, pick the best output.

SECTION 02

AI-Assisted Composition & MIDI

3 Audiocraft (Meta)

github.com/facebookresearch/audiocraft

✓ Completely free

Best for: Unlimited generation · Texture beds · Ambient loops

What it does: Open-source AI audio generation — music, sound effects, and audio continuation from text or audio prompts. Runs locally on your machine with no credits or subscriptions.

The workflow: Use the MusicGen model for background music and texture generation. Feed it an audio clip as a "continuation" prompt to extend or evolve a loop you've already made. Best for texture beds, ambient layers, and sound design elements you'll process further in your DAW.

COPY-PASTE PROMPTS

```
Ambient electronic, slow evolving pads, no drums, cinematic, underwater feeling
```

```
Upbeat funk, slap bass, brass stabs, 110bpm, tight groove, clean mix
```

```
Dark orchestral, low strings, tension building, no resolution, horror film influence
```

HONEST TAKE

The quality ceiling is lower than Suno/Udio but it's 100% free and runs locally. Requires some technical setup (Python, GPU recommended). Worth the one-time setup effort if you're budget-conscious or want unlimited generation without worrying about credits.

4 Magenta Studio

magenta.tensorflow.org · Google · Free Max for Live devices

✓ Completely free

Best for: Ableton users · MIDI variation · Humanizing timing

What it does: A suite of AI MIDI tools that run inside Ableton Live as Max for Live devices. Completely free, works inside your existing DAW.

The tools:

- **Continue** — feed it 4 bars of MIDI, it generates a continuation
- **Groove** — apply humanized timing from a reference performance
- **Drumify** — generate drum patterns from a melody input
- **Interpolate** — blend between two MIDI clips for interesting transitions

The killer workflow: Write a basic chord progression → run through Continue → get 8 variations → pick the best → combine with your original. Doubles your ideas in under 2 minutes.

> HONEST TAKE
>
> Criminally underused by most producers. The Groove tool alone is worth the download — it takes stiff MIDI and makes it feel human. Free, stable, and integrates directly into Ableton. If you're on Ableton and haven't installed this yet, do it today.

5 AIVA

aiva.ai

✓ Free tier

Best for: Cinematic · Film/TV · Orchestral composition

What it does: AI composition platform specializing in orchestral and cinematic music. Generates full arrangements with sheet music export and MIDI download.

The workflow: Generate a full orchestral sketch in AIVA, export the MIDI, pull individual instrument tracks into your DAW, and humanize them. You get the compositional structure from AI — you handle the final sound design and expression.

STYLE DIRECTIONS TO TRY

```
Epic orchestral → build tension → climax → resolution (3 min)

Minimalist piano solo → sparse strings enter at 1:00 → swell at 2:00

Electronic hybrid score → drums + strings + synth bass → cinematic trailer feel
```

HONEST TAKE

Not for EDM or hip hop. Genuinely excellent for cinematic and orchestral work. The MIDI export is the real value — treat the audio output as a sketch and rebuild it with better sample libraries in your DAW.

SECTION 03

Mixing & Mastering AI

6 iZotope Ozone

izotope.com/ozone · AI Master Assistant

Paid — watch for 50–80% off sales

Best for: Self-mastering · Fast starting point · Any genre

What it does: Industry-standard mastering suite with an AI Master Assistant that analyzes your mix and suggests a full mastering chain — EQ, compression, limiting, stereo width, everything.

The workflow:

- Bounce your mix to a stereo file (24-bit WAV, headroom at -6dBFS)
- Open Ozone on the master bus
- Hit "Master Assistant" → set your target (streaming/CD/vinyl)
- Let it analyze → review suggestions module by module
- Tweak from there — don't accept everything blindly

MASTER ASSISTANT SETTINGS GUIDE

```
Target: Streaming (Spotify/Apple Music) → Intensity: Medium → Reference: commercial
track in your genre

Tip: Always review the Imager (stereo width) — AI tends to push it wider than
needed on dense mixes

Tip: Check the Maximizer ceiling — set to -1.0 dBTP for streaming compliance
```

HONEST TAKE

The AI starting point saves 30–45 minutes per master. The suggestions aren't always perfect but they're always a solid foundation. iZotope runs sales constantly — never pay full price. Worth every penny if you're self-mastering regularly.

7 Landr

landr.com

✓ Free tier (low-res)

Best for: Demos · Quick reference masters · Fast turnaround

What it does: Cloud-based AI mastering — upload a mix, get a mastered file back in minutes.

The workflow: Export your mix at 24-bit WAV → upload to Landr → choose intensity → download and A/B against your unmastered mix.

```
SETTINGS GUIDE

Intensity: Always start on LOW — Medium and High over-compress on most mixes

Use case: Demos, client previews, reference checks — not for final commercial
release
```

> **HONEST TAKE**
>
> Great for demos and quick reference checks. Not a replacement for a real mastering engineer on important releases. The Low intensity setting is almost always better than High — the AI over-compresses aggressively on higher settings.

8 Accusonus ERA Bundle

accusonus.com · AI Noise Repair

✓ ERA-D free version

Best for: Vocal cleanup · Room noise · Bedroom recordings

What it does: One-knob AI audio repair tools — noise reduction, de-reverb, de-clip, and voice leveling.

The workflow: Recorded a vocal take in a roomy bedroom? Stack these three in order:

- ERA Noise Remover → ERA De-Reverb → ERA Voice Leveler
- Three plugins, three knobs, clean vocal in under 2 minutes

SINGLE-KNOB SETTINGS GUIDE

```
Noise Remover: 30–50% (higher = more artifacts, less is more)

De-Reverb: 20–40% (start at 20%, increase carefully)

Voice Leveler: 60–70% for consistent level across a performance
```

> **HONEST TAKE**
>
> The "one knob" approach sounds gimmicky but genuinely works for light-to-moderate problems. Don't expect miracles on badly recorded audio — garbage in, garbage out. For good recordings with minor room issues, it's the fastest fix available.

SECTION 04

Stem Splitting & Sampling

9 Moises

moises.ai · ~$4/month

✓ Free tier

Best for: Sampling · Remixing · Learning songs by ear

What it does: AI stem separation — splits any song into vocals, drums, bass, piano, guitar, and other instruments.

The sampling workflow:

- Upload a jazz record → isolate the piano stem
- Chop the cleanest 2-bar phrase in your DAW
- Pitch-shift to your key → layer under your beat
- Clean sample, no bleed from other instruments

> HONEST TAKE
>
> The separation quality has gotten genuinely good — bass and drums isolate cleanly on most modern recordings. Older recordings with heavy reverb are trickier. The mobile app is excellent for on-the-go use. At ~$4/month it's one of the best value tools in this guide.

10 Spleeter

github.com/deezer/spleeter · Deezer · Open Source

✓ Completely free

Best for: Heavy sampling work · Batch processing · No subscription

What it does: Free, open-source stem separation that runs locally. Batch process entire record collections or sample packs.

BASIC COMMAND LINE USAGE

```
spleeter separate -p spleeter:4stems audio/mysong.mp3

spleeter separate -p spleeter:5stems -o output/ audio/mysong.mp3
```

HONEST TAKE

Quality is slightly behind Moises but it's free and unlimited. If you're doing heavy sampling work and need to process lots of files, Spleeter is the move. Also available with GUI wrappers if you don't want to use the command line.

SECTION 05

Sound Design & Synth AI

11 Synplant 2

soniccharge.com · ~$99 one-time

Free trial | Best for: Sound design · Patch matching · Unique textures

What it does: AI-powered synthesizer with a "Genopatch" feature — drop in any sound and it generates a synthesizer patch that matches it.

The workflow:

- Find a sound you love (reference track, sample pack, anywhere)
- Drop it into Genopatch
- Synplant analyzes and grows a synthesizer patch matching that sound
- Rotate through genetic variations to find the sweetest version
- Export the patch and use it in your productions

> HONEST TAKE
>
> Genuinely mind-blowing for sound design. The organic, evolving nature of the Synplant interface combined with AI patch generation opens up sounds you'd never program manually. One of the most creatively unique AI tools in this guide. The trial is worth taking just to experience the Genopatch workflow.

12 AudioShake

audioshake.ai

Limited free credits

Best for: Sync licensing · Professional stems · Complex mixes

What it does: Professional-grade AI stem separation with noticeably better quality on complex, dense mixes. Focused on sync licensing and professional stem delivery use cases.

> HONEST TAKE
>
> The separation quality is noticeably better than Moises on complex, dense mixes — worth the cost if you're delivering stems professionally or working on sync deals. Overkill for casual sampling. Use Moises for day-to-day, AudioShake for professional deliveries.

SECTION 06

AI Workflow & Productivity

13 ChatGPT / Claude

chat.openai.com · claude.ai · Lyric & Concept Writing

✓ Free tiers available

Best for: Lyrics · Concept development · Creative blocks

What it does: Large language models that can write lyrics, develop song concepts, suggest structures, and help break creative blocks. Use as a co-writer, not a ghostwriter.

The key: Specificity. Vague prompts get generic output. Specific prompts — emotion, reference artists, rhyme scheme, syllable count — get usable material.

PROMPTS THAT ACTUALLY WORK

```
I'm making a dark R&B track about the feeling of a relationship slowly falling
apart — both people know it but nobody says anything. Give me 5 different angles I
could take for the concept, from most literal to most abstract.
```

```
Write a verse for a trap song about late night studio sessions. Voice:
introspective, not bragging. Reference artists: Kendrick Lamar, J. Cole. 8 bars,
AABB rhyme scheme.
```

```
I have this hook: [your hook here]. Give me 3 different verse concepts that could
lead into this hook from different emotional directions.
```

HONEST TAKE

The more specific your prompt, the better the output. Always rewrite and personalize what it gives you — use it as raw material, not a finished product. Both ChatGPT and Claude work well; run both on important prompts and take the best lines from each.

14 Notion AI

notion.so · Project & Release Planning

✓ Limited free actions

Best for: Release campaigns · Press kits · Project planning

What it does: AI writing and organization assistant built into Notion — helps plan releases, write press kits, manage project timelines, and draft pitch emails.

RELEASE PLANNING PROMPT

```
I'm releasing an EP in 8 weeks. Genre: lo-fi hip hop. Target audience: college
students, study music listeners. Create a week-by-week release campaign plan
including: social media content themes, playlist pitching timeline, and key
milestones.
```

HONEST TAKE

Underrated for independent producers. Most of us are bad at the business side — release planning, press kits, playlist pitching. Having AI handle the planning templates means you spend more time making music and less time staring at a blank project management doc.

---

15 Soundraw

soundraw.io · ~$17/month

✓ Free preview

Best for: Content music · Studying arrangement · Royalty-free backgrounds

What it does: AI music generation customizable by mood, genre, tempo, and length. Royalty-free. Designed for content creators but genuinely useful as a study tool for producers.

The producer use case: Generate 10 variations of a genre you're working in and analyze what arrangement choices the AI makes — where it drops the energy, how it builds, where elements enter and exit. Fast way to absorb structural patterns.

HONEST TAKE

More flexible than Suno/Udio for content creation use cases where you need specific lengths, no vocals, and guaranteed royalty-free use. Less useful for making original music. The arrangement study use case alone makes it worth the free trial.

BONUS

3 Sample Workflows

These are end-to-end workflows combining multiple tools from this guide. Each one is designed to be completed in a single session.

⚡ Workflow 1: Beat From Scratch in 45 Minutes

1. **Suno** (5 min) — Generate 4 reference sketches for your vibe/mood. Pick the direction that resonates.
2. **Magenta Studio** (10 min) — Generate MIDI variations from your chosen direction. Pick the best 2–3 ideas.
3. **DAW** (20 min) — Build the beat using Magenta MIDI + your own samples and sounds.
4. **Moises** (5 min) — Rip a clean bass stem from a reference track for low-end comparison.
5. **Ozone** (5 min) — Quick AI master for the demo bounce. Set to streaming, medium intensity.

Workflow 2: Remix / Flip

1. **Moises or Spleeter** — Separate the source track into clean stems.
2. **Synplant 2** — Drop the lead synth stem into Genopatch. Generate a matching patch to use as your own sound.
3. **ChatGPT** — Develop a new lyric concept if adding your own vocals to the remix.
4. **Landr** — Master the final bounce on Low intensity for quick distribution.

Workflow 3: Vocalist Session Prep

1. **ChatGPT** — Develop 3 concept directions for the song before the session. Arrive with a clear creative direction.
2. **Suno** — Generate a demo vocal reference for the key and melody direction. Helps vocalists understand the vibe quickly.
3. **Accusonus ERA** — Clean up the recorded vocal takes after the session. Noise Remover → De-Reverb → Voice Leveler.
4. **Ozone** — Master the final mix. Use a reference track in your genre for the AI starting point.

QUICK REFERENCE

Tools by Budget

Start free, add paid tools as your workflow demands them. Every free tool in this guide is genuinely useful — don't feel like you need to spend money to get started.

✓ FREE ONLY

- → Magenta Studio (Ableton)
- → Spleeter (open source)
- → Audiocraft (Meta)
- → ChatGPT / Claude (free tiers)
- → Suno / Udio (daily credits)

UNDER $20/MONTH

- → Moises (~$4/month)
- → Landr (~$12/month or per-master)
- → Soundraw (~$17/month)

ONE-TIME PURCHASE

- → Synplant 2 (~$99)
- → iZotope Ozone (watch for sales — often $50–$100)

FREE TRIAL WORTH TAKING

- → AIVA (free tier available)
- → AudioShake (free credits)
- → Accusonus ERA-D (free version)

The DAW is still yours.

The producers winning with AI right now aren't replacing their skills with it. They're using it to move faster, explore more ideas, and spend their real creative energy where it matters.

Use these tools to get unstuck faster. Use them to generate ideas you'd never have alone. Use them to handle the tedious stuff so you can focus on the art.

The ear is still yours. AI just handed you a better toolkit.

— Milo Wave AI

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